

CARIBBEAN EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL

SECONDARY EDUCATION CERTIFICATE
EXAMINATION

ENGLISH B

Paper 01 – General Proficiency

1½ hours

13 MAY 2009 (p.m.)

In addition to the 1½ hours allowed for the examination, you are allowed 15 minutes in order to read through the entire paper.

You may write during the 15-minute period.

ANSWER ALL QUESTIONS IN THIS PAPER.

Each question is worth 15 marks.

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ANSWER ALL QUESTIONS IN THIS PAPER.

SECTION A – DRAMA

1. Read the following extract carefully and answer ALL the questions that follow.

The demonstrating crowd enters the stage chanting slogans and carrying badly written posters. They sit down cheering and clapping and then fall into silence as the stranger resumes his speech.

5 STRANGER: Yes, I, the stranger among you, I was one of those who fought for Uhuru¹ in the forests and in the detention camps. But what has this Uhuru brought us?

CROWD: Nothing. It has brought us nothing!

STRANGER: Not nothing! It has brought us people who love driving Mercedes Benz, and long American cars! While we starve in the slums! Let the City Council leave us alone in our slums and our misery!

10 CROWD: Long live the stranger! Long live our houses!

STRANGER: I don't want to speak for long. But I want to say this: I don't work magic. I have not the powers of a witch doctor. I cannot blind the eyes of a determined City Council.

15 CROWD: What is he saying? Why does he say this? He can help us? He *must* help us!

20 STRANGER: But there *is* magic! The magic is within you. The witchcraft with which to blind the City Council is within our hearts, in our hands. Let us stand together. Let us, with one voice, tell the government: We want our homes, we love them. Unless the City Council shows us another place to go, where we can earn our bread, we shall not lift a finger to demolish our homes! I go further: we must defend our own!

CROWD: Long live Uhuru Market!² Long live Uhuru Market!

1st CUSTOMER: I don't like this kind of talk.

2nd CUSTOMER: I think he speaks well.

25 3rd CUSTOMER: It is true what he says. We must all stand together.

1st CUSTOMER: Listen – the stranger is speaking again.

STRANGER: Friends, remember how we fought the white man! How many of our sons and daughters withered away in detention camps, and in the forests. We fought for land! But where is the land?

30 CROWD: The white man has got it! Yes, the white man has got it!

STRANGER: We fought for Uhuru, because we were told it would mean decent houses, and decent jobs! But where are those jobs? Where are the houses?

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CROWD: Not here! Not here!

Police siren approaching

35 1st CUSTOMER: Police! The police are coming!

2nd CUSTOMER: Run! Run quickly! Out of my way!

3rd CUSTOMER: But we should stand firm! The stranger said ...

STRANGER: Brothers and sisters! I beseech you not to run away! Your cause is just! Your homes are dear to you!

40 1st CUSTOMER: Watch out! They've got batons! Watch out!

3rd CUSTOMER: Stay, brother, stay!

2nd CUSTOMER: No, no! Let me go. Let me go!

STRANGER: Our people ... our people ... our people ...

Police storm in hitting people with batons, people scream, shout, as they fight to get away.

45 POLICE OFFICER: I am a police officer. In the name of our new Republic, you are arrested for inciting a crowd to violence and civil disobedience! Follow us!

STRANGER: *(last despairing appeal)*: Friends!

CROWD: *makes sullen mutterings which fade into silence*

POLICE OFFICER: Come! Take him away, men!

*Ngugi Wa Thiong'o, "This Time Tomorrow".
Short African Plays, Heineman Educational
Books, 1972, pp. 198 - 201.*

¹ Uhuru means independence.

² Uhuru Market is a market named in honour of the country's independence.

- (a) What impression of the Crowd does the playwright hope to evoke by the opening stage directions? **(2 marks)**
- (b) Identify TWO stage props and state why EACH is important. **(4 marks)**
- (c) State TWO dramatic functions that are served by the behaviour of Customers and the Crowd. **(4 marks)**
- (d) Give THREE pieces of evidence which prove that the Stranger's claim about the Crowd's magic is false. **(3 marks)**
- (e) Identify TWO different feelings that this extract evokes in the audience. **(2 marks)**

Total 15 marks

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SECTION B – POETRY

2. Read the following poem carefully and answer ALL the questions that follow.

The Tightrope Walker¹
(For Norman W. Manley)²

Later, they said that
he should have had more

of the acrobat, of the circus
in his saunter, more tinsel
5 and more trumpet in his dream.
They wanted tumblers, tyrannies,
all the spangled flattery
he would not pretend;
he went too straightly, balancing
10 his vision towards
our common end.

You measure a man by
the space that his going makes;
the air, now, is full of his absence;
15 the tent is still.
Gather his books and the medals.
The lights go down
over the quiet arena
over the sea and the hill;
20 the music descends
to a funeral sorrow.
Silence each clown.
But, when the show begins again
and the big drums beat
25 and the grinning performers circle the ring
on their deceptive feet
remember the high road he walked, higher
than the glitter or the glory
of the show
30 following the simpleness
of that determined cord
across the dangerous
tempting fame below.

*Adapted from Dennis Scott, "The Tightrope Walker".
In Andrew Salkey (ed), Breaklight: An Anthology of Caribbean Poetry.
Hamish Hamilton 1971, pp. 121 – 122.*

- ¹ A tightrope walker is an acrobat who performs on a rope or cable stretched taut above the ground.
² Norman W. Manley was a former Prime Minister of Jamaica.

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- (a) Who does “they” refer to in line 1? (1 mark)
- (b) Lines 3 – 5 describe what was expected of Manley. What figure of speech is used and what makes it effective? (4 marks)
- (c) Select an image that conveys Manley’s values and comment on its effectiveness. (4 marks)
- (d) What is the mood in lines 15 – 22? Give a reason for your answer. (3 marks)
- (e) Suggest ONE reason why the title of the poem is effective. (3 marks)

Total 15 marks

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SECTION C – PROSE FICTION

3. Read the following extract carefully and answer ALL the questions that follow.

That night was special. Goldman beat drum for the whole wake. He beat like he was working out something, saying something to his mother, to everybody who feel they know him. Beat like he saying, “This is me. This is Elsie Mason one son. This is the beat she bless me with. Dance if you want. Dance if you have the belly.” He talk his
5 drum until the hurt he was carrying find a voice to sing so sweet plenty people couldn’t resist the sound. Whole night the village dance as one, and each step was the gift they bring to make a fullness that nobody question. When they lower Miss Elsie in her grave first thing Glorious Saturday, Goldman cry so much for his mother, it didn’t have a dry eye in the place.

10 Whole day Moons sit down in the house. She never move to turn a pot. She sit down there like she was Jesus self lock up in the tomb, waiting for the call to wake up and walk right out. That night of the wake, Moons hear something. Not a word, but a sound enter her and travel deep down. She couldn’t tell what it was, but the taste of rum wasn’t sweet like the talk in the drums, and when Smooth come easing up, his tongue slick from
15 the babash¹ he was hitting whole night with Santo, Moons tell him to leave her alone; she didn’t want him troubling her no more.

First, he stand back and size her up to see if she was really serious. She hold her ground and meet the question in his stance.

“I finish,” she say direct, like a hammer hitting a nail.

20 And like a sling-shot he blurt out, “No problem. It have more fish in the sea. If that is what you want?”

¹ Babash is a local rum.

Jennifer Rahim, “The Wedding”.
Songster and Other Stories.
Peepal Tree Press 2007, pp. 114 – 115.

- (a) What is the main event being described in paragraph 1? **(1 mark)**
- (b) (i) What impression does the writer create of
- Goldman?
 - Miss Elsie?
- (ii) For EACH of the characters give TWO pieces of evidence from the passage to support your answer in (b) (i) above. **(6 marks)**
- (c) Explain the central conflict Moons is experiencing in this passage. **(3 marks)**
- (d) Identify ONE figure of speech in paragraph 2 that emphasizes Moons' conflict and comment on its effectiveness. **(4 marks)**
- (e) Suggest ONE word to describe Moons' tone of voice in line 19. **(1 mark)**

Total 15 marks**END OF TEST**

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